vested political interests of the Centre, it resulted into promoting an imbalanced growth.

In the recent years governments have tried to address the major criticism of planning in India. More such constructive steps with better results are expected in future. More aware and better informed citizens will lead to better and better planning in future.

There has been a general anger among the sections of society regarding the coalition politics, scams, etc. in recent years. The ***Economic Survey 2011-12*** rightly *blames coalition politics* and the *federal structure* for tardy decision making in several areas - from oil subsidy to tax reforms, FDI in retail and free movement of foodgrains. Almost everyone outside the government blamed it for *policy paralysis*. The Survey notes it as an area of concern. The Survey notes that ***politicians*** and ***policymakers*** can set the ball rolling by acting as ***role models*** but it also cited the poor record on enforcement of contract to argue that people's attitude needs to change. "*In these everyday situations (such as hiring a cab or a painter) it is cumbersome to bring in the state and the law courts. Here the main guarantor has to be people's personal integrity and trustworthiness,*" it says. The statement comes from a government that has been battling a spate of *corruption scandals* - ranging from those in the telecom sector to Commonwealth Games and criticism over poor governance standards and inability to push through critical decisions[103] .

The ***Economic Survey 2012-13*** has suggested a new objective for the Planning Commission – the global economic and financial crisis which has persisted for the last five years has not only exposed the vulnerability of almost all the countries over the globe to external shocks, but also has lessons for the ***planning process*** – countries need to have inbuilt social safety nets for facing such eventualities, which affect the weak and vulnerable the most, and wipe out the fruits of growth for ears. India with its focus on inclusive development and timely interventions has, however, been able to weather the crisis better than many other countries.[104]

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1. J.K. Galbraith, ***A History of Economics,*** Penguin Books, London, 1991, p. 187.